

Need battery?

Intel's Pine Trail platform improves battery life, but doesn't match NVIDIA's ION in graphics performance

Chrome 520

VIA confident about their Chrome 520 graphics solution that promises Blu-ray playback using hardware acceleration

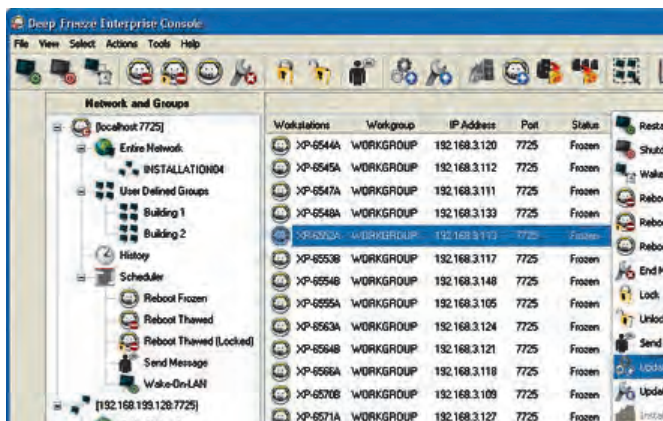
Q&A

Most motherboards with on-board graphics use a part of the system memory as graphics memory. This has to be set from the BIOS itself. If you haven't changed it, then it might be using the default 256 MB. We suggest upgrading to 2 GB of memory anyway.

Most cabinets don't support HD audio on the front ports. You'll have to use the AC97 codec option in the BIOS and use those connectors from the

Master and slaves problems

I have just assembled my new PC and am facing a problem while installing the OS. The BIOS detects the hard drive as Master, but it does not detect my DVD drive. I'm unable to boot from the DVD drive. The HDD and the DVD drive are both IDE. I am using a single IDE cable to connect them. The DVD drive powers up properly and I can eject



Deep Freeze helps prevent any kind of data damage or loss

motherboard to the front panel for it to work.

Frozen in place

I had installed Deep Freeze, but it isn't getting uninstalled. It does not show up in the Control Panel or in the system tray. I have manually ended the process through the task manager and deleted the software from the Program Files. After restarting the computer however, it comes back. What should I do?

Moshai Dada

One of the easiest ways is to try installing the software once again and then removing it from the Control Panel. Also, look for an uninstallation application in the installation folder or within the Start menu.

the tray normally. I suspect a jumper issue here.

The DVD drive has three sets of pins labelled as – MA, SL, CS. The jumper is on the MA pin. My system configuration is as follows:

- Motherboard – Gigabyte GA-EP45-UD3L

- PSU – Cooler Master Extreme Power 460W
 - GPU – ZOTAC GeForce GTX260
 - CPU – Intel Core 2 Duo E7400
 - RAM – Kingston 1 GB 800 MHz
- Also, please let me know if the

460 W PSU should be enough for my GPU. I also plan to get a 320GB / 500 GB WD HDD next month. Do you foresee any power issues?

Denis S. D'Souza

Make sure that the hard drive is set as the master drive and the DVD drive as the Slave. Here, MA stands for Master, SL for Slave and CS for Cable Select. There cannot be two master drives or slave drives on a single IDE interface.

A good 460 W PSU should be just about sufficient for your configuration. An additional hard drive shouldn't be a problem.

Windows error

My desktop PC configuration is as follows:

- Processor – Intel Core 2 Duo E7400
- Motherboard – GIGABYTE S series
- RAM – Umax 1 GB
- HDD – Samsung 160 GB
- Monitor – AOC 18.5-inch LCD

I installed Windows XP (SP3) on my system, but after booting it started hanging, showing errors and I was not able to access any application on my system. I reinstalled the OS but it failed. I would also like

Memtest86+ to ensure that there are no problems with it. Yes, you can install Windows 7 on your system.

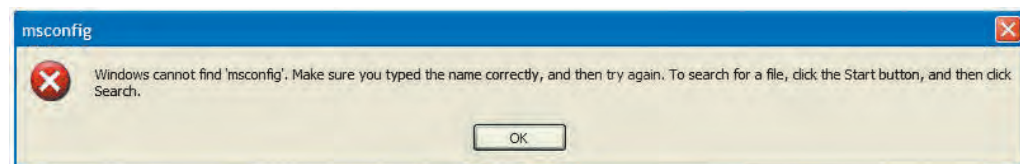
MSCONFIG missing

My age old machine (Pentium 4 – 1.7 GHz, Intel 845 motherboard, 512 SD RAM with Windows XP SP3) recently refusing to open MSCONFIG. I run Comodo Firewall and Avast 4.8 Home. I have also performed full scan with Ad Aware 2009, Spybot, Bit Defender, Advanced System Care, Doctor Alex, EMCO malware destroyer and several others with out any help. All scan reports indicate there is no infection. All the above mentioned software have been updated.

Sudipta Sarkar

The application msconfig might be corrupted or missing. There could be another reason – the PATH variable might have been changed. Try clicking on Start > Run. Type C:\WINDOWS\SYSTEM32\MSCONFIG.EXE. Check if it runs. If yes, then the variables need to be reset.

Press [Windows] + [Pause]. Go to the Advanced



Missing or corrupted MSCONFIG can throw up such errors

to know whether I can install Windows7 on my system.

Ravi Shankar Chakravorty

The problem might be with the hard drive or memory. You'll have to run a thorough disk scan and use

system properties and look for system variables. Add an entry for C:\WINDOWS\SYSTEM32\ for PATH variable.

If MSCONFIG.EXE isn't present, repair it using the Windows installation disc.